

Instructor Information

Teacher : Ms. Mir

Class time : M - Th 9.45 - 10.50 AM

Contact Info : use Canvas inbox or mshantu@byu.edu

Office Hour : Only by Appointments. Remember that the duration of each meeting is 15-30 minutes depending on the day. Please be punctual.

CLICK ON THE LINK TO ARRANGE AN APPOINTMENT

NOW : <https://calendly.com/shantonamir61/30min>[Links to an external site.](#)

Course Description

This course helps students master the basics of writing paragraphs and writing target structures accurately.

Course Learning Outcomes

1. Writes level appropriate* drafted and timed text.
 1. Writes groups of sentences.
 2. Connects sentences with similar meaning or purpose
 3. Formulates yes/no questions.
 4. Formulates wh- questions.
2. Produces target structures accurately.
 1. Uses subject, verb, object statement structure.
 2. Demonstrates subject/verb agreement in controlled contexts.
 3. Uses a variety of regular and irregular verbs
 4. Uses capitalization correctly.
 5. Uses punctuation correctly.
 6. Uses basic syntax correctly.
3. Incorporates high frequency general vocabulary in writing.
 1. Recombines learned vocabulary into memorized phrases and structures.
 2. Spells high frequency general vocabulary correctly.

Textbook

- **Great Writing 2: Great Paragraphs**, 5th edition, ISBN: 978-

0357020838.

- You **cannot** use an old textbook. Your textbook needs to be blank (no writing or answers from other students). A textbook with an online code needs to be new.

You should bring these materials EVERY DAY:

- Notebook, Pen/ Pencil
- Your Textbook
- Blue Book
- Laptop/ Phone
- Your Learning Check-up Sheet

Ms. Mir 's Classroom Rules

1. Bring **all** the required materials everyday in class.
2. Be **kind** and **respectful** to other classmates and your teacher.
3. Be **on time** to class. If you miss 10 minutes of class (either at the beginning, middle, or end) you will be considered **absent**.
4. **Check your grades** regularly and make an appointment if you have concerns.
5. Come **prepared**. Bring all the necessary materials.
6. Use class time effectively. **Ask questions**. Pay attention. Don't work on other things in class. Use English.

7. **Please don't use your phones** unless you do class work. In case of an emergency, seek permission.
8. Turn in your **homework** on time.
9. Have **patience** with yourself and with others. Encourage others. Be enthusiastic and positive. Have fun.

Grades

You have **two** different grades: a **Proficiency grade** and a **Learning Experience** grade. The Proficiency grade shows your language ability, and your Learning Experience grade shows your active participation in class.

Proficiency

The Proficiency grade shows how well you understand and use English. This grade includes drafted paragraphs, timed writing, Perfect Paragraphs, Chapter Tests, and Integrated Writing. **You usually need a Proficiency grade above 74% to move to the next level at the end of the semester.** If your Proficiency grade is low, you may be dismissed.

Drafted Paragraphs (30%)

You will write a one-page paper with a few paragraphs. First, write a rough draft, then share it with a classmate for feedback. After that, write your final draft to turn in for a grade. You will work on your paper in class and can also work on it at home.

Timed Writing/ Quizzes (30%)

Timed Writing Assignments will take a Timed Writing test/ Typing to practice writing quickly, like on the LATs. You will have 10 minutes to write one paragraph on a given topic. You will be graded on grammar and vocabulary we learn in class.

Perfect Paragraphs/ Chapter Tests (25%)

Each week, you will write a "Perfect Paragraph" in the blue books. On Monday, you will write a paragraph, and the next day, I will give you feedback. You will edit your paragraph every day until it's perfect. On Thursday, you will type it on Canvas and get a grade. Chapter tests will be given to review the grammar and vocabulary that you learn each week.

Integrated Writing (15%)

What is Integrated Writing?

Integrated Writing helps you practice using information from **two sources**:

1. **A reading passage** (something you'll read).
2. **An audio clip** (something you'll listen to).

After reading and listening, you'll write a response that explains how the two are connected. This will teach you how to organize ideas and write clearly, just like you'll need to do in school and work!

What Will You Learn?

- How to **find important ideas** in what you read and listen to.
- How to **combine (integrate)** information from both sources.
- How to write a clear, organized response.
- How to use **simple and correct grammar** to express your ideas.

Late Proficiency Assignment Policy

You can complete a Proficiency assignment late. A late assignment does *not* automatically lose points. You need to complete the assignment before your teacher reports grades (every three weeks: **February 3, February 24, March 17, and April 7.**)

If your absence is too close to the grade report, your teacher can give you an extra week. If you do not complete the late assignment by the new deadline, your grade will be 0.

Your teacher can decide to excuse a missed proficiency assignment.

Learning Experiences

Learning Experience grades show your effort to learn, practice, and apply your ELC lessons. Some Learning Experience grades will be in the class. Some will be assignments you complete at home. Going to class does not mean that you automatically earn a good Learning Experience grade. You need to actively participate and complete assignments on time. **You need more than 80% for your Learning Experience** grade or you can be dismissed.

Examples of Learning Experiences in this skill area include: completion of workbook assignments, peer reviews, attending writing conferences, submitting a draft for completion grade, extended group work tasks, review activities, preparing outside of class for an in-class task.

Late Learning Experience Policy

Learning Experiences need to be completed by the due date.

If you have an excused absence, your teacher can choose to accept a late learning experience assignment before the grade report days (every three weeks: **February 3, February 24, March 17 and April 7.**) If your excused absence is too close to the grade report, your teacher can give you an extra week. Your teacher can also choose to excuse the Learning Experience. **Unexcused assignments will receive 0, and late assignments will incur a score of 10% per day.**

You cannot complete every unexcused Learning Experience late, so you need to talk to your teacher. You will have a 0 for some unexcused Learning Experiences.

Language Acquisition Tests (LATs)

Language Acquisition Tests (LATs) are the final test in the semester. You will have a reading, writing, listening, and speaking test. All students at the ELC take the same tests. You must take the LATs or the semester will be incomplete.

This semester, you will take your LATs on **April 16th and 17th.**

[Attendance Policy](#)[Links to an external site.](#)

ELC students must maintain 80% attendance in every course. When a student's attendance goes below 80% in any one of the four courses, that student receives a warning letter and is put on attendance probation. Any additional unexcused absences before raising your attendance back to in dismissal from the ELC program. Upon receiving an attendance dismissal letter, students should go to the Admissions Office (105 UPC).

Students are marked absent when they

- are more than 10 minutes late,
- miss more than 10 minutes of class,
- or leave more than 10 minutes early

When absent, students should contact their teachers to receive information on missed learning experiences.

Some absences may be excused. Students who are sick and unable to attend class should provide a doctor's note to the Teacher and Student Services Office (103 UPC) within two days of returning to class. Students should also notify ELC administration in writing of any planned absences, (for example: a family wedding or a death in the family). These documents should be delivered to the same office (UPC 103). These absences will be considered on an individual basis and may not necessarily be excused.

Preventing Sexual Discrimination & Harassment

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 is intended to eliminate sex discrimination and sexual harassment in educational contexts. Any ELC student who becomes aware of sexual harassment, discrimination, or misconduct of any kind, directed toward them or any other member of the ELC community should immediately contact Sandy Hatchett (801-422-5318, sandy_hatchett@byu.edu) or Dr. Ben McMurry (801-422-8521, ben_mcmurry@byu.edu), they will work with you and report to the Title IX office.

[Students with Disabilities](#)[Links to an external site.](#)

Students with Disabilities should meet with the Student Services Advisor for help in identifying ways to accommodate any special needs. Teachers who suspect or are aware that one of your students has a disability, should also contact the Student Services Advisor (801-422-5318). If ELC teachers receive notice of disability document from a student or from another entity on campus, the teacher should share the letter with the Student Advisor as soon as possible.

Accommodations for students are agreed upon by two administrators.

[Academic Honesty](#)[Links to an external site.](#)

ELC students should be honest with others, complete their own work and be evaluated based upon that work, and avoid academic dishonesty including cheating, falsification, and plagiarism. To learn more about the definitions of cheating, falsification and plagiarism, visit the [ELC Policies page](#)[Links to an external site.](#).

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Artificial Intelligence (AI) refers to tools that make decisions or generate original content based on existing content. In this program, our goal is to help you become capable English language users whose behavior and moral character are an example of honesty, excellence, and integrity.

This policy is to clarify appropriate use of AI tools (such as ChatGPT). The use of AI in academic work should meet the following requirements.

- AI cannot be used in any test at the ELC.
- AI can only be used as approved by the instructor of the course. For example:
 - AI may be used in the prewriting process.
 - AI may be used to help revise you own writing.
- A note should be always included at the end of the assignment explaining how AI was used.

Academic integrity: The use of AI to create work that is intended to deceive or misrepresent the student's abilities, contribution, or knowledge is strictly prohibited and will be treated the same as plagiarism. This includes plagiarism, or representing others' work as one's own. Any use of AI should also adhere to established law and BYU's plagiarism policy: <https://policy.byu.edu/view/academic-honesty-policy>[Links to an external site.](#)

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Calendar

Mondays	Tuesdays	Wednesdays	Thursdays	Fridays
Grammar	Typing Practice	Timed Writing	Fluency Writing/Quizzes	Journal Writing
Textbook (Unit)	10 Perfect Sentences	Textbook Activities	Textbook Activities	Chapter Quizzes

Calendar : <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1a3UhB6dqCyo6HFquKBrvhryrHDti65HO/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=100889755891810342623&rtpof=true&sd=true>[Links to an external site.](#)

